

Zsolt Varjú

Software Developer

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Summary

Software developer and platform operator. I build web applications end to end, design the data pipelines that feed them, and run the production infrastructure they depend on. At Serco I own and run a platform for the European Space Agency that delivers quality reports and data unavailability reports from Earth observation satellites, aggregating validated data from ESA, legacy and third-party missions, from choosing the approach to keeping it running in production. I experiment with AI tools and keep learning them, because I believe they are the compilers of our decade. Heading towards system architecture.

Experience

Software Developer

Serco Czech Republic s.r.o. · Prague, Czechia · Feb 2025 – Present

- Own and run, end to end, a platform for the European Space Agency that delivers quality reports and data unavailability reports from Earth observation satellites, aggregating validated data from ESA, legacy and third-party missions.
- Choose the approach, technologies and architecture for new work, present it, build it, take it through UAT to production, and keep it running: monitoring, fixes, patches and backups.
- Develop the frontend, the backend and the data ingestion pipelines, and maintain the automation scripts around them.
- Administer the platform's two Ubuntu servers: containers, CI/CD, updates, backups, access control and regular vulnerability remediation under formal change control.
- Led the migration of a legacy service from Ubuntu 18.04 to a new Ubuntu 24.04 LTS server: dockerised the legacy codebase so it runs on the new host, closed the outstanding vulnerability findings and brought the server under regular patching, and replaced a manual multi-step deployment with a single automated, zero-downtime release.
- Led a phased frontend quality programme: vendor bundle cut by roughly three quarters, JavaScript payload down a third, CSS down more than half, unnecessary re-renders reduced by 80%.
- Work directly with the mission teams and IT on requirements, solution proposals, bug reports, change records and estimates.

Quality Assurance Tester

Galileo Corporation s.r.o · Remote · 2022 – 2025

- Manual functional testing of web pages across browsers and devices, identifying and reporting defects.
- Verified pages against graphic design specifications and fed detailed corrections back to designers and developers.
- Maintained quality standards across a large portfolio of Slovak municipal and commercial websites.
- Documented test results and corrective actions, working independently to fixed deadlines.

Skills

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, Bash, SQL

Web: React, Next.js, Node.js, Express, REST APIs

Search & data: Apache Solr, Open Semantic Search, Tika, Neo4j, RabbitMQ, PostgreSQL, MongoDB

ETL & automation: Custom ingestion pipelines, Cron orchestration, PDF & spreadsheet extraction, Workflow automation

AI & LLM: RAG architecture, Embeddings, Vector search (Qdrant), Hybrid retrieval, Prompt engineering, Claude Code, Codex, OpenRouter, Self-hosted models

DevOps & cloud: Docker, Kubernetes, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Azure, AWS, Dokku, nginx, WireGuard, Tailscale

Security & practice: Vulnerability remediation, TLS, Hardening, Change management, Agile, API testing (Postman)

Projects

Self-Hosted RAG Search

Python, Qdrant, bge-m3, LangChain, Docker

Retrieval-augmented search over a local document collection: hybrid BM25 and vector retrieval, answers grounded in cited passages, and explicit abstention when no supporting evidence is found.

Coffece (coffece.sk)

Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, next-intl

Bilingual SK/EN marketing and ordering site for an office coffee delivery brand, with localised routing, validated order forms and full SEO metadata.

IDT PLUS STAV (idtplusstav.sk)

Next.js, TypeScript, MDX, Dokku, Google Workspace

Complete digital operations for a construction SME: self-hosted marketing site, DKIM-authenticated business email, invoicing configured for Slovak VAT reverse charge, plus Google Ads and SEO.

B2B Wholesale Ordering Portal

WooCommerce, B2BKing, Stock Locations

Production B2B ordering portal for a Slovak wholesaler: tiered customer pricing, login-only catalogue, two-warehouse inventory, decimal quantities for weighted goods and integrated invoicing.

Lemma: Vocabulary Scanner

React Native, Expo, Vision models, FSRS

Mobile app that turns a photo of a printed page into vocabulary cards, pairing a vision-language detection pipeline with FSRS spaced-repetition scheduling.

Personal Infrastructure & Homelab

Linux, Docker, WireGuard, Tailscale, CI/CD

Personal VPS and home server run with production habits: WireGuard private networking, atomic zero-downtime deploys with rollback, self-healing service recovery and scheduled backups.

Education

MSc, Applied Informatics

Constantine the Philosopher University in Nitra · 2018 – 2024

Thesis: InfoMap SK, a full-stack application visualising Slovak open data from the Statistical Office API on an interactive map.

Certifications

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) · Linux Foundation / CNCF

Ubuntu Linux Professional Certificate · Canonical · Apr 2025

Learning Bash Scripting · LinkedIn Learning · Jul 2025

Basics of ABAP Programming on SAP BTP · SAP · Oct 2024

AWS Academy Graduate, Cloud Foundations · AWS Academy · Jul 2022

Languages

Hungarian (native) · Slovak (fluent) · Czech (fluent) · English (fluent)